

1947 & THE NEW PAKISTAN

"A new country began building a new state."

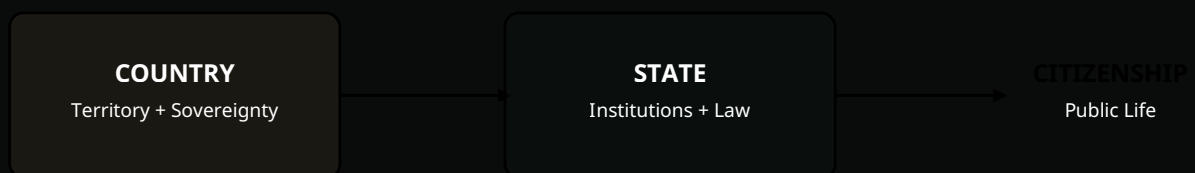
Creating a country is one event. Building a state is another. In August 1947, Pakistan appeared on the political map as a new country. But a country needs institutions, laws, administration, borders, and citizens. Most importantly, it needs relationships between the state and the communities within it. For Orakzai communities, the beginning of Pakistan marked not an ending, but the start of a new political relationship. The flag had changed; the state had changed. But the mountains, families, languages, and customs remained. The question was how the new Pakistan would relate to them.



“A new country began building a new state: the conceptual integration of frontier and national institutions.”

COUNTRY VS. STATE

Political science distinguishes between a **country** (territory, sovereignty, and population) and a **state** (institutions, administration, law, and authority). In 1947, Pakistan achieved sovereignty, but the building of state institutions was a gradual process. For the frontier, this meant adapting colonial structures—like the Political Agency system—to a new national framework. Sovereignty was created in a moment; the state developed over generations.⁴



“The logical path from national sovereignty to public life.”

THE FIRST YEARS: A TIMELINE

The first decade of Pakistan was marked by consolidation and constitutional debate. For Orakzai, then part of the **Frontier Region (FR) Kohat**, this period involved maintaining tribal stability while the state defined its ideological character through the **Objectives Resolution of 1949**.^{1 3}

1947	**Independence** : Termination of British paramountcy; Operation Curzon (troop withdrawal).
1948	**Consolidation** : Jinnah signs new agreements with tribal jirgas; state stability prioritized.
1949	**Ideology** : Objectives Resolution defines Pakistan as an Islamic and democratic state.
1955	**Reorganization** : One Unit scheme merges West Pakistan provinces; tribal areas remain FATA.

ORAKZAI AND THE STATE HIERARCHY

In the early Pakistan period, Orakzai was not a separate Agency but was administratively linked to Kohat district as a Frontier Region. The state interacted with the community through a established hierarchy: the ****Political Agent**** (representing the state), the ****Maliks**** (tribal intermediaries), and the ****Jirga**** (the customary council). This structure provided a channel for negotiation and administrative communication.⁵



“The administrative channel between the state and the Orakzai community.”

Historical change in the frontier was uneven. While sovereignty and citizenship were new, tribal institutions and customary law remained central to everyday life. The ****Frontier Crimes Regulation (FCR)****, inherited from the colonial era, continued to be the primary legal framework, creating a state of "perpetual transition" where old tools managed a new national reality.⁶

CATEGORY	STATUS	DESCRIPTION
TRIBAL IDENTITY	CONTINUITY	Clans, lineages, and Pashtunwali remained central.
SOVEREIGNTY	CHANGE	Transition from British Crown to Pakistan state.
LEGAL FRAMEWORK	CONTINUITY	FCR maintained as the primary administrative law.
EDUCATION	SLOW CHANGE	Gradual expansion of government primary schools.

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

Pakistan was born in 1947, but a country is not completed on the day it becomes independent. It is built through years of institutions, decisions, relationships, and ordinary lives. For Orakzai, the new Pakistan did not erase the old world. Families, Pashto, faith, and the mountains remained. But a new political reality surrounded them—a new state claimed sovereignty, and a new citizenship connected people to a national framework. The story of early Pakistan is therefore not simply a story of change; it is a story of continuity meeting change. To understand Orakzai in Pakistan, we must study both.

“PAKISTAN BEGAN IN 1947. THE RELATIONSHIP WAS BUILT OVER GENERATIONS.”

INSTITUTIONAL EVOLUTION ANALYSIS